9.4.1.3 Canadian Smocking or North American Smocking

Canadian smocking is also called as North American Smocking. In this type textural effect is created on the front side of the fabric. No pleating is required for Canadian smocking. A grid is drawn or designed on the back of the fabric. Later it is used to create the three dimensional effect on the front side of the fabric. This type of smocking is not usually pressed or ironed. The texture would be flattened or destroying if the smocked fabric is pressed.

The fabric used should be cut on grain

- Pleating threads are parallel to the cross grain
- Fabric is not damaged by the needles or the pleating machine
- There are no folds, bubbles, or splits
- Any temporary marking have been completely removed
- Smocking is appropriately centered in garment
- No visible break on the front side where the threads have been stopped and restarted
- Stitches catch only the appropriate pleats
- Stitch tension appears consistent for all stitches ;tension is neither too tight that pleats are pinched nor too loose so that thread sags
- Stitch depth is consistent
- Threads within stitches are laid smoothly
- Threads from any back smocking, are not visible on the front of the work

Types of Canadian Smocking

- **Lattice Smocking**

It creates a beautiful pattern on the right side of the fabric. There are a few variations where the pattern of stitches is worked on the front-one of these is called flower smocking. Grid pattern is used to mark designs.

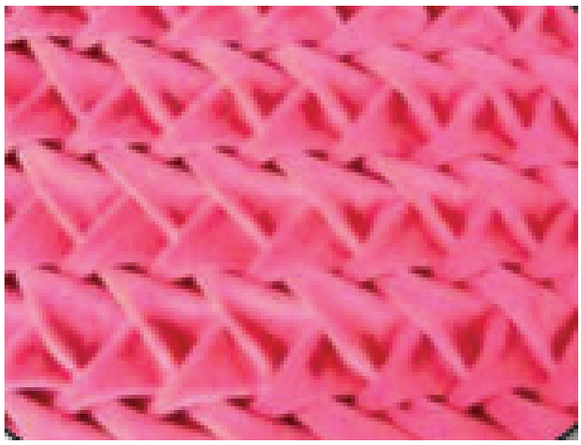


Figure 9.26 Direct Smocking

- **Fabric Smocking**

This smocking is created with the grid pattern. Textural effect is created on the right side of the fabric. Three times more fabric is required and good stretch is created.



Figure 9.27 Direct Smocking

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